



TRAINER SLIDES · WSQ

Effective Project Management for Small Projects

WSQ Course Code: TGS-2020505545 ·

2 days · 16 training hours

TSC: Project Management · ICT-PMT-3026-1.1

Version v18.0 · 19 August 2026

Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd · UEN: 201200696W



COURSE ADMINISTRATION

Welcome & Housekeeping

How the two days work and what evidence you will produce

Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

AM, PM and Assessment

Complete every required SSG digital attendance scan.

Scan the trainer QR

Use your mobile camera and submit the attendance record.

75% minimum

Attendance eligibility is calculated from the official record.

Assessment required

Complete the assessment and achieve Competent for funding eligibility.

Your Trainer

Name

Dr Alfred Ang

Role

Course developer and principal trainer, Tertiary Infotech Academy

Experience

20+ years across engineering, analytics, AI and digital transformation

Contact

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Ground Rules

Participate

Use the tools, challenge assumptions and explain your decisions.

Respect

One conversation at a time; disagree with evidence, not people.

Be punctual

Activities build on one another; missed work creates downstream gaps.

Keep evidence

Save every completed template for the case study and assessment review.

Learning Outcomes — 1 to 4

LO1

Develop project scope and team to initiate the facilitation of a small project

LO2

Develop a realistic project plan based on the agreed project scope

LO3

Utilise appropriate methods and tools to track and drive a project

LO4

Identify, analyse and manage project risks

Learning Outcomes — 5 to 7

LO5

Collaborate effectively with project stakeholders

LO6

Deploy manpower, budget and other resources for efficient completion

LO7

Track project deliverables and correct misalignments through control and closeout

Skills Framework — Abilities A1 to A4

Code	Ability	Practice
A1	Facilitate execution of small projects that are typically less than six months, with limited budget and interdependencies, and no significant strategic impact	Activity 1
A2	Implement realistic project plans based on project objectives and scope	Activity 2
A3	Utilise appropriate methods and tools to track and drive progress against plans and timelines	Activity 3
A4	Identify risks to project success and take appropriate actions to manage them	Activity 4

Every assessed ability has a named tool-based activity.

Skills Framework — Abilities A5 to A7

Code	Ability	Practice
A5	Collaborate effectively with relevant internal and external stakeholders directly impacting the project	Activity 5
A6	Deploy manpower, financial budgets and relevant resources for efficient and effective completion	Activity 6
A7	Track deliverables against schedules, monitor costs, timescales and resources, and take basic corrective actions when misaligned	Activity 7

The seven activities form one connected project evidence trail.

Skills Framework — Knowledge

Code	Knowledge	Taught in
K1	Elements of a small project	Topic 1
K2	Requirements of a project plan	Topic 2
K3	Application of appropriate project management methodologies and tools	Topic 3
K4	Project risks	Topic 4
K5	Project stakeholder identification	Topic 5

Knowledge is applied in the activity immediately following its topic.

Lesson Plan — Day 1

Initiate with value

Topic 1 · charter, boundaries, team and kickoff

Plan the work

Topic 2 · requirements, WBS, schedule, critical path and budget

Drive quality and flow

Topic 3 · visual management, root-cause and prioritisation tools

Manage uncertainty

Topic 4 · risk register, responses, contingency and decision analysis

Lesson Plan — Day 2

Engage stakeholders

Topic 5 · mapping, RACI, communication and engagement

Deploy resources

Topic 6 · capacity, optimisation, procurement and team performance

Control and close

Topic 7 · status, earned value, change, corrective action and handover

Assessment

Written Case Study and Oral Questioning, open book

Course Outline — Topics 1 to 4

Topic 01 · Initiation of a Project

Small-project fit · value · charter · scope · team · kickoff · A1, K1

Topic 02 · Develop a Project Plan

Requirements · scope baseline · WBS · network · schedule · budget · A2, K2

Topic 03 · Apply Methods and Tools to Drive a Project

Quality planning · flow · root cause · Pareto · improvement · A3, K3

Topic 04 · Manage Project Risk

Identify · assess · respond · contingency · monitor · A4, K4

Course Outline — Topics 5 to 7

Topic 05 · Collaborate with Stakeholders

Identify · analyse · communicate · engage · allocate accountability · A5, K5

Topic 06 · Deploy Resources

People · budget · equipment · procurement · team performance · A6

Topic 07 · Track Project Deliverables and Correct Misalignments

Performance · earned value · change · corrective action · handover · closure · A7

The Seven Tool Packs

Activity	Tool pack	Used to
1	Project Charter & Business Case	Define value, scope, authority and success measures
2	WBS, RTM, Network & Gantt	Turn scope into an integrated baseline
3	Fishbone, 5 Whys & Pareto	Diagnose and prioritise quality causes
4	Risk Matrix, Decision Tree & Tornado	Prioritise uncertainty and fund responses
5	Stakeholder Map, RACI & SEAM	Plan influence, accountability and engagement
6	Organisation Chart & Kanban	Deploy people and balance workload
7	Kanban, Burndown, Budget & Control	Track delivery, earned value and corrective action

Every activity folder contains its own editable tools, procedure, worksheet, dataset and acceptance criteria.

One small project runs through all seven activities.

A 42-person Singapore specialty grocer will introduce online ordering and two-hour click-and-collect at three outlets. The five-month pilot has a S\$180,000 cap, a core team of seven, two external suppliers, and limited dependencies. It is important to operations but does not change the company's overall strategy, making it a genuine small project. Success means: Launch at all three outlets by 30 January 2027; process at least 120 pilot orders per week; keep pick accuracy at or above 98%; achieve customer satisfaction of at least 4.2/5; and remain within the approved S\$180,000 budget.

Briefing for Assessment

Individual work

No discussion once assessment begins.

Open book

Slides, Learner Guide and approved materials only.

Protect the paper

No photographs, recording or unauthorised materials.

Answer with evidence

State the method, decision, rationale and expected result.

Final Assessment

Written Case Study

Written Assessment (Case Study) — apply project management judgement to a small-project scenario.

Oral Questioning

Oral Questioning — explain and justify decisions against the course methods and evidence.

Conditions

Open book: course slides, Learner Guide and approved course materials only.

Competency

A minimum of 75% attendance and a Competent result are required for funding eligibility.

TOPIC 01 · A1, K1 · LO1

Initiation of a Project

Small-project fit · value · charter · scope · team · kickoff

Small does not mean informal.

The smaller the project, the less waste it can absorb. A short charter, sharp boundaries and visible decision rights are the control system—not bureaucracy.

Initiation of a Project — Core Concepts I

01

A project is temporary, unique and value-seeking; operations are ongoing and repetitive.

02

A small project is normally under six months, has a limited budget and team, few dependencies and no significant strategic impact.

03

The project manager integrates people, decisions and trade-offs; they do not merely maintain a schedule.

04

Success balances value and outcomes with scope, schedule, cost, quality, resources and risk.

Initiation of a Project — Core Concepts II

05

Predictive, adaptive and hybrid approaches are choices driven by uncertainty, not labels of maturity.

06

The business case tests whether the project should exist; the charter authorises it to exist.

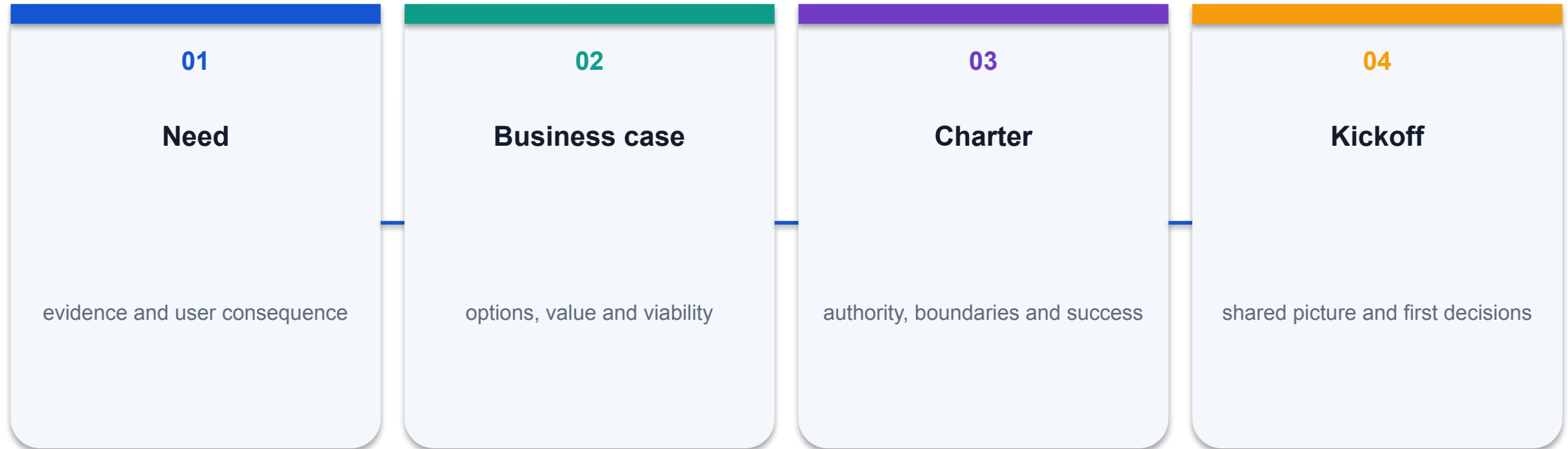
07

A useful charter names purpose, measurable success, scope boundaries, milestones, budget, major risks, team and sponsor authority.

08

A kickoff creates one shared picture of why, what, who, how and what happens next.

From Need to Authorised Work



Do not plan an unauthorised idea as though it were already a project.

Business Case vs Project Charter

Dimension	Business Case	Project Charter
Core question	Should we invest?	Are we authorised to proceed?
Focus	Options, benefits, costs, risk	Purpose, scope, team, milestones
Owner	Sponsor / business owner	Sponsor with project manager
Decision	Select or reject option	Authorize and delegate

Both are living decision records; neither is a ceremonial form.

Choosing a Development Approach

Signal	Predictive	Adaptive / Hybrid
Requirements	Stable and testable upfront	Evolving or discovery-heavy
Feedback	Available late or at gates	Available in short cycles
Change cost	High after commitment	Reduced through increments
Governance	Baseline and stage gates	Timeboxes plus control points

Approach follows uncertainty and reversibility—not fashion.

Activity 1 Tool Pack

02 Cost Benefit Analysis

XLSX · editable project tool

05 Business Case on a Page

DOCX · editable project tool

08 Project Charter Template

XLSX · editable project tool

Authorise the HarbourHub Click & Collect Pilot

THE SITUATION

HarbourHub Fresh has approved discovery work for a click-and-collect pilot at three outlets, but the sponsor has not yet authorised delivery. Operations wants speed, Finance wants a hard S\$180,000 ceiling, store managers fear disruption, and customers want reliable collection times. Your team must decide whether this is a viable small project and define the authority to proceed.

WHAT YOU'LL DO

Validate the customer problem, quantify the investment case, define measurable success, set in/out boundaries, name the core team and sponsor, record assumptions and high-level risks, and prepare the kickoff decision.

YOU'LL PRODUCE

A cost–benefit analysis, one-page business case and signed-ready project charter with measurable success criteria, scope boundaries, milestone dates, budget cap, team and kickoff agenda.

DONE WHEN

The charter proves the work qualifies as a small project, names one accountable sponsor, contains quantified success measures and exclusions, stays within five months and S\$180,000, and carries an explicit authorisation decision.

Tool: Project Charter, Cost–Benefit Analysis and Business Case templates

Full procedure, evidence fields and acceptance criteria: Learner Guide and Activity 1 folder.

Debrief — Activity 1: What It Proves

1

The business case answers whether the project should exist; the charter answers whether the team is authorised to act.

2

A scope boundary is incomplete until exclusions are visible—silence is where scope creep starts.

3

Success criteria must be measurable before the plan is built, or control later becomes opinion.

Topic 01 Recap

Decision

A project is temporary, unique and value-seeking; operations are ongoing and repetitive.

Method

Success balances value and outcomes with scope, schedule, cost, quality, resources and risk.

Evidence

A cost–benefit analysis, one-page business case and signed-ready project charter with measurable success criteria, scope boundaries, milestone dates, budget cap, team and kickoff agenda.

Capability

Develop project scope and team to initiate a five-month small project (A1, K1).

TOPIC 02 · A2, K2 · LO2

Develop a Project Plan

Requirements · scope baseline · WBS · network · schedule · budget

A plan is a connected model, not a collection of files.

Requirements, WBS, dependencies, dates, resources and money must describe the same work. If one changes, the others must move with it.

Develop a Project Plan — Core Concepts I

01

The plan integrates subsidiary decisions; separate scope, schedule and cost files are not yet a project plan.

02

Progressive elaboration and rolling-wave planning add detail as uncertainty reduces without abandoning control.

03

Requirements must be testable, prioritised and traceable from need through deliverable and acceptance evidence.

04

The scope statement defines deliverables, exclusions, constraints, assumptions and acceptance criteria.

Develop a Project Plan — Core Concepts II

05

The WBS decomposes deliverables to manageable work packages; the WBS dictionary removes ambiguity.

06

Dependencies create the network; the longest path sets the earliest finish and carries zero or least float.

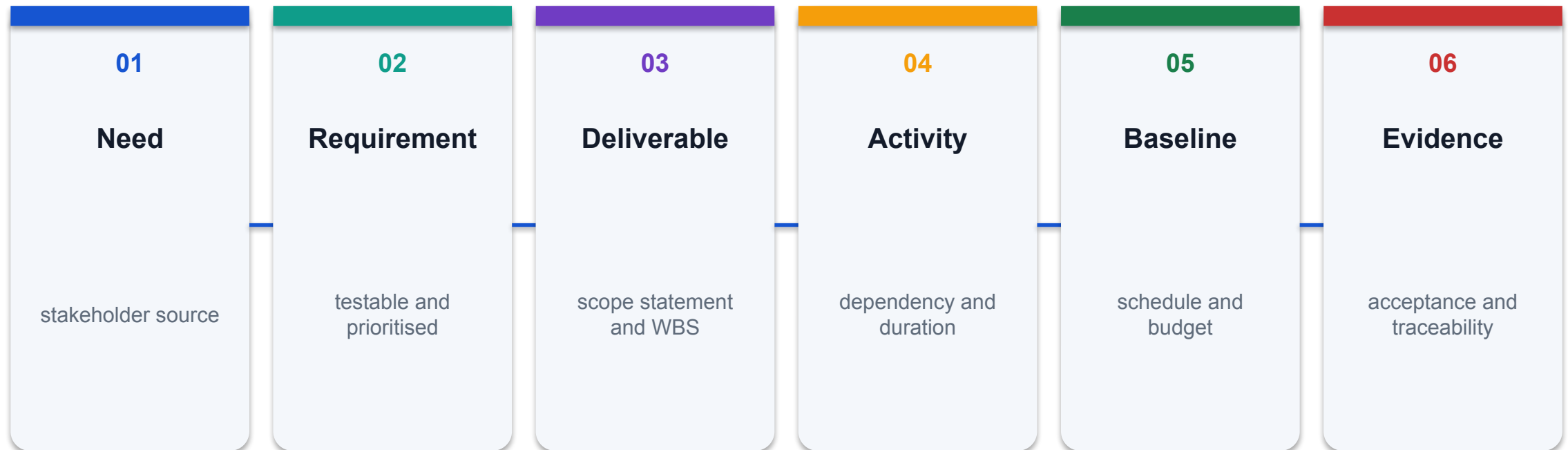
07

Duration estimates should separate work, waiting, risk and resource availability; use analogous, parametric, bottom-up or three-point methods deliberately.

08

The cost baseline is time-phased; contingency reserve covers known-unknowns while management reserve covers unknown-unknowns.

The Planning Chain



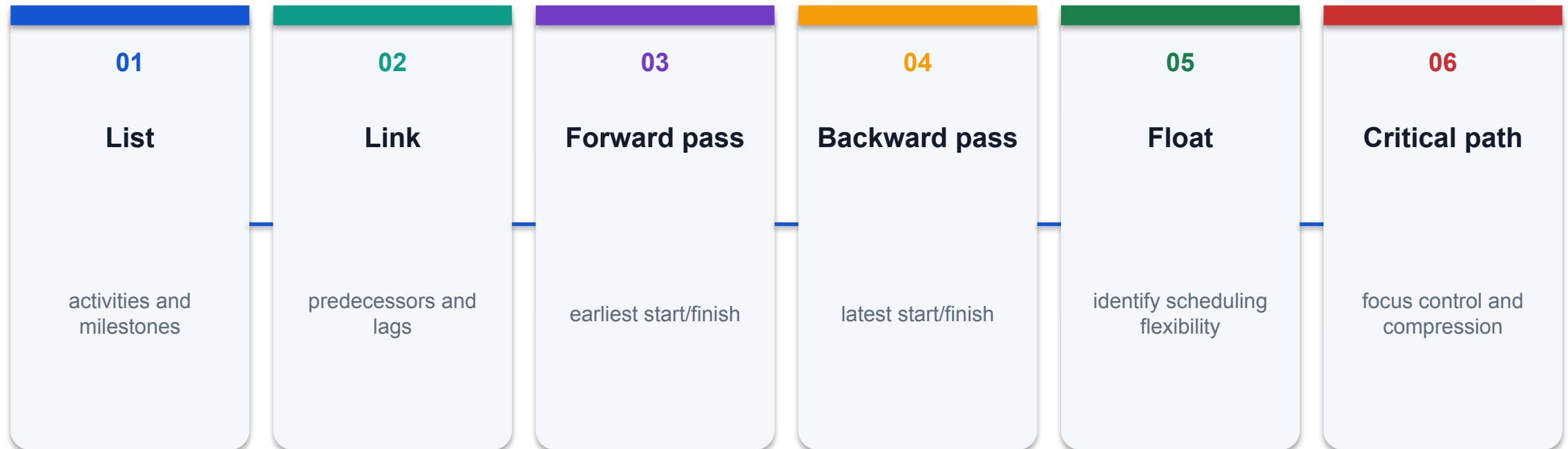
A broken link creates either orphan scope or unplanned work.

Estimating Methods

Method	Best use	Main risk
Analogous	Early estimate from similar work	False similarity
Parametric	Repeatable unit rates	Bad rate or scale
Bottom-up	Defined work packages	Time and detail cost
Three-point	Uncertain durations/costs	Optimism in inputs

Record the basis of estimate so future variance can be explained.

Critical Path Logic



Recalculate after every approved change—the critical path can move.

Activity 2 Tool Pack

24 WBS Dictionary

XLSX · editable project tool

24 Work Breakdown Structure

PPTX · editable project tool

25 Requirements Traceability Matrix

XLSX · editable project tool

28 Schedule Network Diagram

XLSX · editable project tool

29 - Gantt Chart - Schedule - Daily Weekly Monthly and Phases

XLSX · editable project tool

32 Project Budget - Planned vs Actual - Weekly and Monthly

XLSX · editable project tool

Build the Integrated Scope, Schedule and Cost Baseline

THE SITUATION

The sponsor approved the charter with one condition: the three outlets must launch before Lunar New Year trading. You have high-level deliverables but no traceable requirements, work breakdown, dependency logic or time-phased budget. A vendor has proposed a date based only on optimism.

WHAT YOU'LL DO

Translate the charter into testable requirements, a deliverable-oriented WBS and dictionary, then sequence work, estimate duration and cost, calculate the critical path, and publish an integrated baseline.

YOU'LL PRODUCE

A requirements traceability matrix, WBS and dictionary, network diagram with critical path and float, Gantt schedule with milestones, and time-phased S\$180,000 cost baseline with contingency reserve.

DONE WHEN

Every requirement traces to acceptance evidence and a WBS deliverable; the network produces a defensible critical path; the Gantt fits the five-month limit; and all scheduled work is funded within S\$180,000.

Tool: RTM, WBS, network, Gantt and budget templates

Full procedure, evidence fields and acceptance criteria: Learner Guide and Activity 2 folder.

Debrief — Activity 2: What It Proves

1

A Gantt chart is an output of dependency logic, not a substitute for it.

2

The integrated baseline is only credible when scope, schedule and cost reconcile to the same work packages.

3

Float belongs to the project, not automatically to the activity owner who happens to see it.

Topic 02 Recap

Decision

The plan integrates subsidiary decisions; separate scope, schedule and cost files are not yet a project plan.

Method

The scope statement defines deliverables, exclusions, constraints, assumptions and acceptance criteria.

Evidence

A requirements traceability matrix, WBS and dictionary, network diagram with critical path and float, Gantt schedule with milestones, and time-phased S\$180,000 cost baseline with contingency reserve.

Capability

Implement a realistic project plan from the authorised objectives and scope (A2, K2).

TOPIC 03 · A3, K3 · LO3

Apply Methods and Tools to Drive a Project

Quality planning · flow · root cause · Pareto · improvement

Use the lightest tool that changes the next decision.

A tool earns its place when it turns uncertain work into visible evidence: flow, cause, variation, priority or ownership.

Apply Methods and Tools to Drive a Project — Core Concepts I

01

A method defines how work is managed; a tool makes information visible. Choose both for the decision needed.

02

Predictive plans optimise sequence and baseline control; adaptive boards optimise flow and feedback; hybrid combines both intentionally.

03

Quality means conformance to requirements and fitness for use, not luxury or perfection.

04

Prevention and appraisal are usually cheaper than internal and external failure.

Apply Methods and Tools to Drive a Project — Core Concepts II

05

A check sheet captures facts, a control chart detects process behaviour, Pareto prioritises causes, and fishbone plus 5 Whys investigates root cause.

06

Root-cause analysis must end at a process or system cause the team can influence, not blame a person.

07

Visual work management exposes blocked work and excessive WIP before the schedule report does.

08

Continuous improvement closes the loop through a named action, owner, measure and review date.

Select the Tool for the Question

Question	Best starting tool	Output
What happened?	Check sheet	Reliable facts
Why might it happen?	Fishbone	Cause families
What is the root?	5 Whys	Actionable chain
Which causes matter most?	Pareto	Vital few
Is the process stable?	Control chart	Common vs special cause

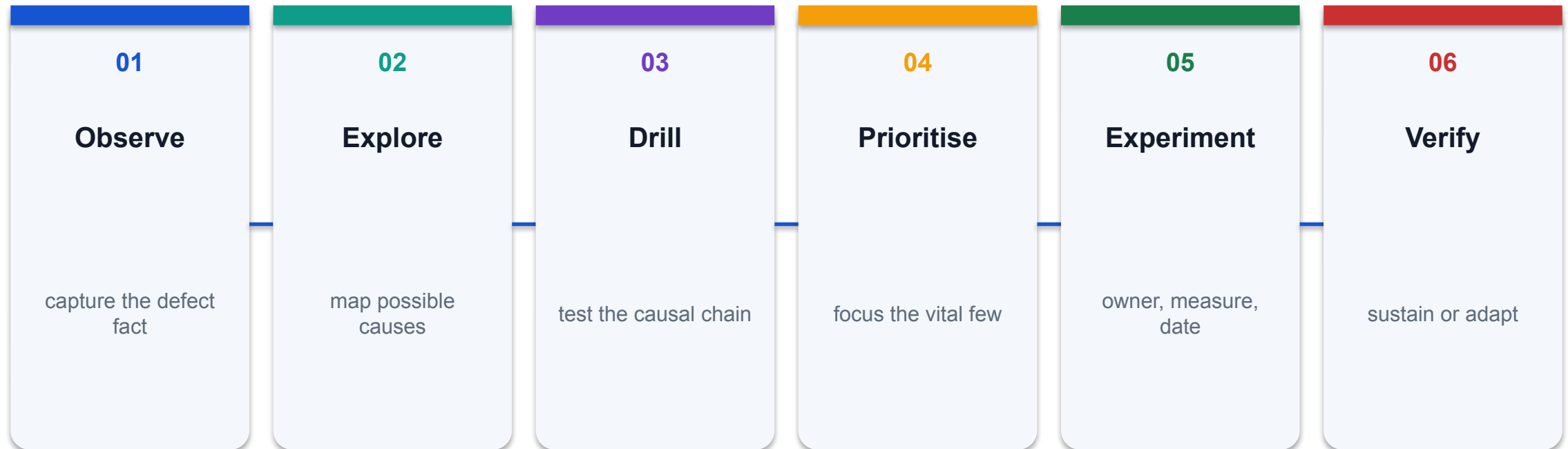
Tools work as a sequence: facts → causes → priority → behaviour → action.

Cost of Quality

Category	Purpose	Example
Prevention	Stop defects forming	Training and standards
Appraisal	Detect before release	Review and testing
Internal failure	Fix before customer	Rework and retest
External failure	Recover after release	Returns and reputation

Invest upstream where a dollar of prevention avoids many dollars of failure.

Root Cause to Improvement



Stopping at a cause without a verified action is analysis theatre.

Activity 3 Tool Pack

35 Check Sheets

XLSX · editable project tool

37 Ishikawa Diagram

XLSX · editable project tool

38 Five Whys

XLSX · editable project tool

36 Pareto Principle Template

XLSX · editable project tool

34 Control Chart

XLSX · editable project tool

Diagnose and Prioritise the Pilot's Quality Failure

THE SITUATION

During outlet testing, only 82% of orders are ready at the promised collection time and pick accuracy has fallen to 94%. The software vendor blames store staff; store staff blame late inventory updates. The sponsor wants action before the team has separated symptoms, causes and normal variation.

WHAT YOU'LL DO

Capture defect facts, map potential causes, drill to an actionable root cause, rank the vital few, interpret process behaviour and commit one measurable improvement action.

YOU'LL PRODUCE

A reconciled check sheet, fishbone diagram, five-level causal chain, Pareto chart, control-chart interpretation and a SMART corrective experiment with owner and review date.

DONE WHEN

The data total reconciles; Pareto reaches 100%; the five-whys chain ends at an actionable cause; the control chart interpretation matches the pattern; and the corrective experiment has an owner, measure and review date.

Tool: Fishbone, Check Sheet, 5 Whys, Pareto and Control Chart

Full procedure, evidence fields and acceptance criteria: Learner Guide and Activity 3 folder.

Debrief — Activity 3: What It Proves

1

Fishbone broadens the search, 5 Whys deepens one chain, and Pareto tells you which chain is worth funding first.

2

A control limit describes process behaviour; it is not the same as a customer specification limit.

3

Improvement becomes project work only when it has capacity, ownership and a verification date.

Topic 03 Recap

Decision

A method defines how work is managed; a tool makes information visible. Choose both for the decision needed.

Method

Prevention and appraisal are usually cheaper than internal and external failure.

Evidence

A reconciled check sheet, fishbone diagram, five-level causal chain, Pareto chart, control-chart interpretation and a SMART corrective experiment with owner and review date.

Capability

Use appropriate methods and tools to drive progress and improve quality (A3, K3).

TOPIC 04 · A4, K4 · LO4

Manage Project Risk

Identify · assess · respond · contingency · monitor

Risk management buys options before they become expensive.

The register matters only when it changes funding, sequencing, ownership or contingency before a trigger becomes an issue.

Manage Project Risk — Core Concepts I

01

Risk is an uncertain event or condition with a positive or negative effect; an issue has already happened.

02

Write risks as cause-event-impact statements so the response targets the cause or reduces the impact.

03

The risk register records owner, probability, impact, exposure, triggers, response, contingency and residual risk.

04

Qualitative analysis prioritises quickly; quantitative analysis estimates the range of outcomes and decision value.

Manage Project Risk — Core Concepts II

05

Threat responses are avoid, mitigate, transfer, accept or escalate; opportunity responses are exploit, enhance, share, accept or escalate.

06

A contingency plan is triggered by an observable threshold and funded from contingency reserve.

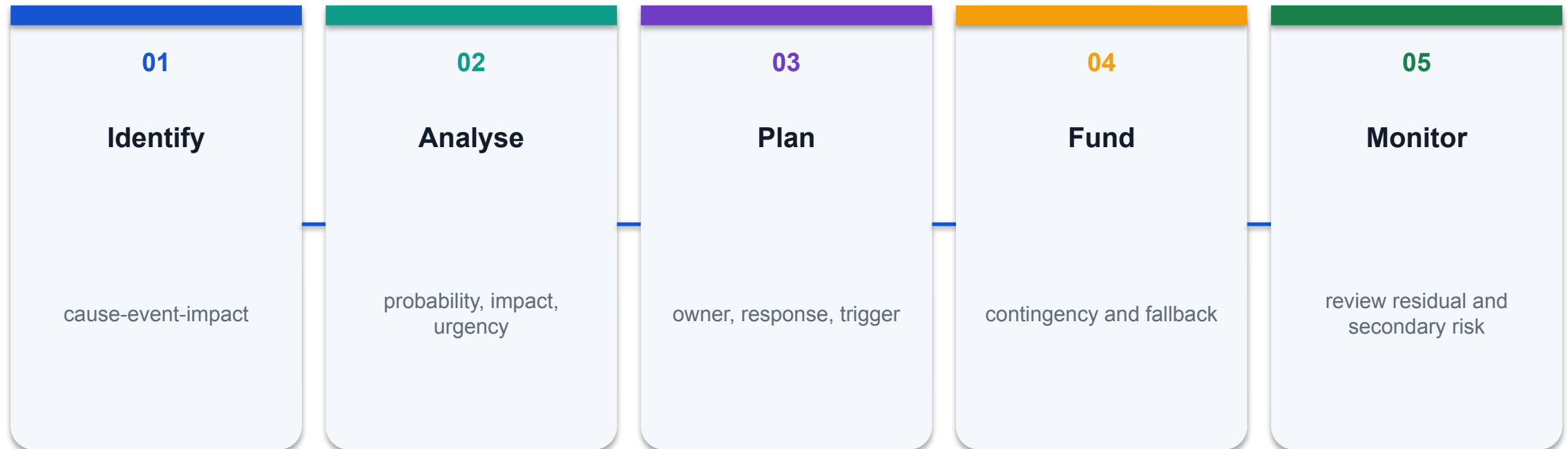
07

Decision trees compare expected monetary value; tornado charts reveal which assumptions deserve the most attention.

08

Risk reviews are recurring decisions, not a register created once and archived.

The Risk Cycle



Triggered risk becomes an issue and moves into action management.

Threat Response Choices

Response	What changes	Example
Avoid	Remove the threat source	Change approach
Mitigate	Reduce probability or impact	Prototype early
Transfer	Shift financial consequence	Insurance / contract
Accept	Monitor and prepare	Contingency plan
Escalate	Move beyond authority	Sponsor decision

Acceptance is a decision with monitoring—not forgetting the risk.

Qualitative vs Quantitative Analysis

Lens	Qualitative	Quantitative
Speed	Fast prioritisation	More data and effort
Output	Relative exposure	Range, EMV or sensitivity
Use	Most project risks	Material decision uncertainty
Caution	Scoring bias	False precision

Use quantitative analysis only where the decision value justifies the work.

Activity 4 Tool Pack

48 Risk Assessment Matrix Two pages

XLSX · editable project tool

45 Decision Tree Analysis TDIDT

XLSX · editable project tool

49 Tornado Chart - Sensitivity Analysis

XLSX · editable project tool

Build the Risk Register and Fund the Right Responses

THE SITUATION

The pilot has entered build. The POS interface may be delivered late, refrigerated stock counts are unreliable at one outlet, a key trainer is available for only two weeks, and a faster payment option could improve adoption but costs more. The remaining contingency reserve is S\$18,000.

WHAT YOU'LL DO

Write cause-event-impact risk statements, score and rank exposure, assign owners and triggers, choose responses, compare alternatives by expected monetary value and allocate the limited contingency reserve.

YOU'LL PRODUCE

A prioritised risk register with owners, triggers, responses, contingency and residual exposure; one decision-tree recommendation; one tornado sensitivity reading; and a reconciled S\$18,000 reserve plan.

DONE WHEN

Every priority risk has cause-event-impact wording, an owner, trigger, funded response and residual score; the decision-tree arithmetic reconciles; and the named contingency allocations total no more than S\$18,000.

Tool: Risk Matrix, Decision Tree and Tornado templates

Full procedure, evidence fields and acceptance criteria: Learner Guide and Activity 4 folder.

Debrief — Activity 4: What It Proves

1

An owner does not prevent a risk; they watch the trigger and ensure the agreed response is ready.

2

Contingency is not generic padding—it is a funded response to identified uncertainty.

3

Quantitative tools sharpen a decision but do not replace judgement about reputation, safety or compliance.

Topic 04 Recap

Decision

Risk is an uncertain event or condition with a positive or negative effect; an issue has already happened.

Method

Qualitative analysis prioritises quickly; quantitative analysis estimates the range of outcomes and decision value.

Evidence

A prioritised risk register with owners, triggers, responses, contingency and residual exposure; one decision-tree recommendation; one tornado sensitivity reading; and a reconciled S\$18,000 reserve plan.

Capability

Identify risks to project success and take proportionate action (A4, K4).

DAY 1 CLOSE

End of Day 1

Save Activities 1–4. Day 2 continues the same project from the approved risk-aware baseline.

TOPIC 05 · A5, K5 · LO5

Collaborate with Stakeholders

Identify · analyse · communicate · engage · allocate accountability

Stakeholder engagement is part of delivery.

Every unresolved expectation eventually appears as a delay, rejected deliverable, unapproved invoice or uncontrolled change.

Collaborate with Stakeholders — Core Concepts I

01

A stakeholder can affect, be affected by, or perceive themselves to be affected by the project.

02

The stakeholder register captures interest, influence, expectations, impact, communication needs and engagement strategy.

03

Power-interest mapping guides attention; the salience model adds legitimacy and urgency.

04

The engagement assessment matrix compares current and desired states so the gap becomes actionable.

Collaborate with Stakeholders — Core Concepts II

05

RACI clarifies who is Responsible, Accountable, Consulted and Informed; every deliverable needs one clear Accountable owner.

06

Communication planning matches audience, message, channel, frequency, owner and feedback route.

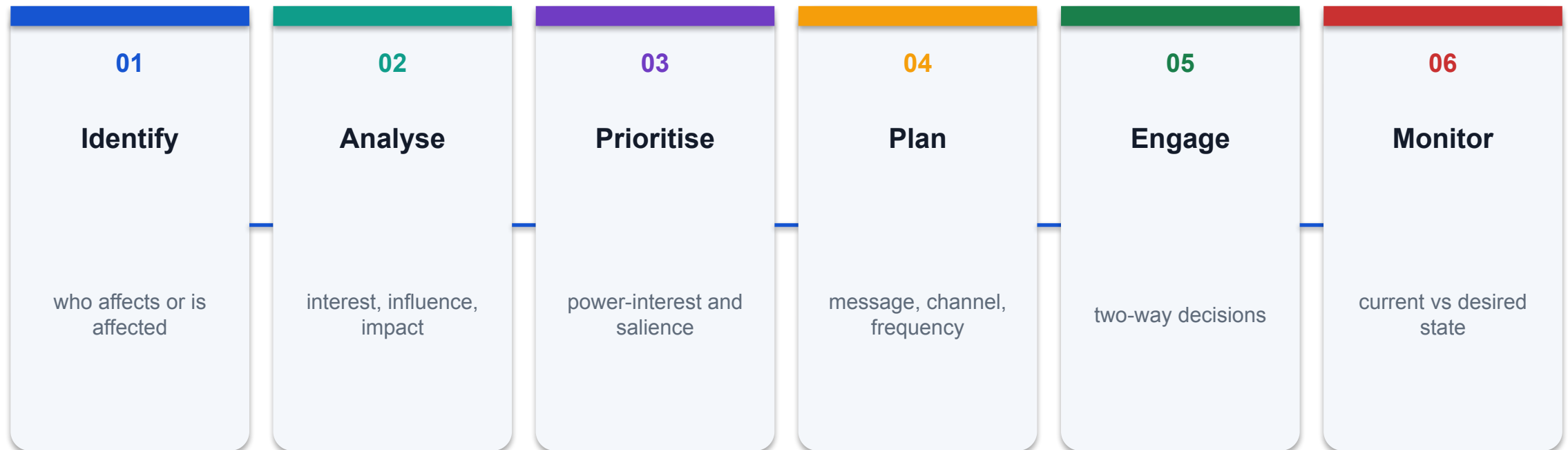
07

Engagement is two-way sense-making and decision participation, not one-way broadcasting.

08

Escalation should state the decision needed, options, impact of delay and recommendation.

Stakeholder Analysis to Engagement



A stakeholder register is useful only when it changes an engagement action.

RACI Diagnostic

Pattern	Meaning	Correction
No A	Nobody owns the outcome	Assign one accountable owner
Multiple A	Competing decision rights	Choose one and define escalation
No R	No one performs the work	Assign delivery responsibility
Too many C	Decision gridlock	Consult only for needed input
Everyone I	Broadcast without purpose	Tailor information needs

Use deliverables and decisions as rows; vague verbs create vague accountability.

Communication vs Engagement

Dimension	Communication	Engagement
Direction	Often one-way	Two-way
Purpose	Share information	Shape decisions and commitment
Evidence	Message delivered	Feedback changed the work
Risk	Noise and overload	Unresolved expectations

The channel matters less than whether the stakeholder can influence the decision in time.

Activity 5 Tool Pack

42 Stakeholder Impact Over Influence Matrix

XLSX · editable project tool

43 Salience Chart

PPTX · editable project tool

39 RACI Template

XLSX · editable project tool

41 Stakeholder Engagement Assessment Matrix

XLSX · editable project tool

Align Stakeholders with a Map, RACI and Engagement Plan

THE SITUATION

Two weeks before outlet testing, the POS vendor and operations manager each believe the other owns interface acceptance. Store managers receive conflicting instructions, Finance has not approved the payment milestone, and a high-influence outlet supervisor is quietly resisting the pilot.

WHAT YOU'LL DO

Identify and analyse stakeholders, prioritise engagement, remove duplicate or missing accountability, and define a two-way communication rhythm tied to upcoming decisions.

YOU'LL PRODUCE

A stakeholder register and power-interest map, salience reading, validated RACI matrix, current-to-desired engagement assessment, communication plan and one evidence-based escalation brief.

DONE WHEN

All material stakeholders are analysed; every critical deliverable has exactly one Accountable owner and at least one Responsible party; engagement gaps have two-way actions; and the escalation asks for a clear decision.

Tool: Stakeholder Map, Salience, RACI and Engagement Assessment

Full procedure, evidence fields and acceptance criteria: Learner Guide and Activity 5 folder.

Debrief — Activity 5: What It Proves

1

Most collaboration failures are decision-right failures before they become communication failures.

2

RACI clarifies accountability; it does not replace the conversation needed to gain commitment.

3

Stakeholder attention should follow evidence of influence, impact and urgency—not organisational seniority alone.

Topic 05 Recap

Decision

A stakeholder can affect, be affected by, or perceive themselves to be affected by the project.

Method

The engagement assessment matrix compares current and desired states so the gap becomes actionable.

Evidence

A stakeholder register and power-interest map, salience reading, validated RACI matrix, current-to-desired engagement assessment, communication plan and one evidence-based escalation brief.

Capability

Collaborate with internal and external stakeholders directly impacting the project (A5, K5).

TOPIC 06 · A6 · LO6

Deploy Resources

People · budget · equipment · procurement · team performance

Capacity—not headcount—delivers the plan.

A seven-person team may have only three usable person-days at the constraint. Resource deployment is the discipline of matching skills and time to the critical work.

Deploy Resources — Core Concepts I

01

Resource planning links each work package to required skills, quantities, timing and availability.

02

A responsibility assignment is not a capacity plan; availability must be tested against concurrent work.

03

Resource levelling changes dates to resolve over-allocation; smoothing stays within available float.

04

Fast tracking overlaps work and raises risk; crashing adds cost to critical-path work and may not shorten the project.

Deploy Resources — Core Concepts II

05

Procurement decisions consider make-or-buy, lead time, quality, interfaces, contract type and vendor capability.

06

Tuckman's stages require adaptive leadership: direct, coach, support and delegate as the team matures.

07

Conflict is normal; collaborate for important relationships and outcomes, compromise when time is limited, and escalate only with evidence.

08

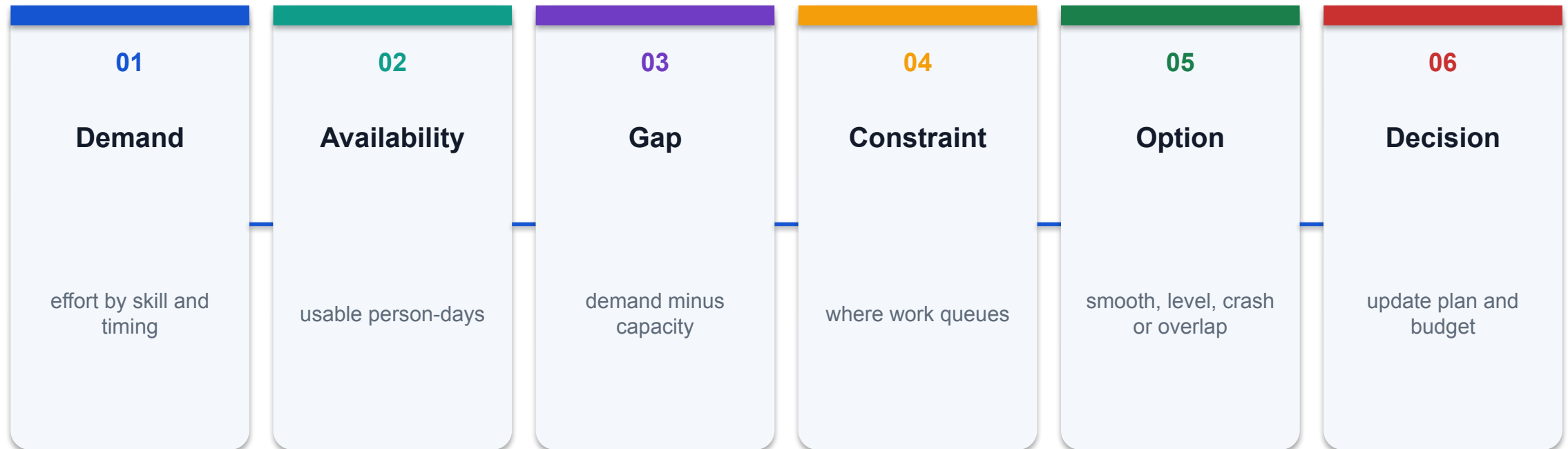
A resource dashboard should show demand, capacity, variance, bottlenecks and decisions—not just headcount.

Four Resource Responses

Option	Schedule effect	Cost / risk effect
Smoothing	Uses float; finish unchanged	Low cost, limited relief
Levelling	May delay finish	Resolves over-allocation
Crashing	Shortens critical work	Adds cost; diminishing returns
Fast tracking	Overlaps sequence	Adds rework and quality risk

Apply compression only to the current critical path and reanalyse after the change.

Capacity Planning



Capacity is time and skill together; headcount alone is not a usable measure.

Team Stage and Leadership

Stage	Team signal	Leader response
Forming	Unclear roles and dependence	Direct and clarify
Storming	Conflict and boundary testing	Coach and facilitate
Norming	Shared standards emerge	Support and reinforce
Performing	Autonomous delivery	Delegate and protect
Adjourning	Transition and loss	Recognise and close

Using one leadership style for every stage creates either dependence or frustration.

Activity 6 Tool Pack

40 Organisation Chart

PPTX · editable project tool

30 Kanban Board

XLSX · editable project tool

32 Project Budget - Planned vs Actual - Weekly and Monthly

XLSX · editable project tool

Deploy the Team and Resolve the Resource Bottleneck

THE SITUATION

The test plan needs 22 person-days in the next two weeks, but only 16 are available. The same business analyst is assigned to testing, training materials and vendor clarification. The sponsor refuses a launch delay unless the team proves no lower-cost option exists.

WHAT YOU'LL DO

Map roles and capacity, expose over-allocation, compare smoothing, levelling, crashing and fast tracking, re-sequence work on a Kanban board and recommend a resource decision with cost and risk evidence.

YOU'LL PRODUCE

A two-week capacity plan, organisation and escalation map, workload Kanban, evaluated compression options, reconciled budget impact and a sponsor recommendation that removes the bottleneck.

DONE WHEN

The plan reconciles named work with actual capacity; the bottleneck is visible; each optimisation option has schedule, cost and risk consequences; and the chosen deployment fits the approved project constraints.

Tool: Organisation Chart, Kanban Board and Project Budget templates

Full procedure, evidence fields and acceptance criteria: Learner Guide and Activity 6 folder.

Debrief — Activity 6: What It Proves

1

A name in a RACI matrix does not create capacity; capacity must be measured against concurrent demand.

2

Fast tracking buys time with risk, while crashing buys time with cost—neither is automatically a good decision.

3

Manage the constraint first. Adding capacity elsewhere can increase WIP without improving delivery.

Topic 06 Recap

Decision

Resource planning links each work package to required skills, quantities, timing and availability.

Method

Fast tracking overlaps work and raises risk; crashing adds cost to critical-path work and may not shorten the project.

Evidence

A two-week capacity plan, organisation and escalation map, workload Kanban, evaluated compression options, reconciled budget impact and a sponsor recommendation that removes the bottleneck.

Capability

Deploy manpower, budget and relevant resources for efficient completion (A6).

TOPIC 07 · A7 · LO7

Track Project Deliverables and Correct Misalignments

Performance · earned value · change · corrective action · handover · closure

Control means deciding early enough to change the outcome.

Variance reporting without forecast, ownership and action is history. Good control protects value and makes closure evidence-ready.

Track Project Deliverables and Correct Misalignments — Core Concepts I

01

Work performance data becomes information only after comparison with the approved baseline and thresholds.

02

A status report should answer: where are we, why, what is forecast, what decision is needed, and who owns the action.

03

Earned value integrates scope, schedule and cost: PV is planned work, EV is completed value, and AC is actual spend.

04

$CPI = EV/AC$ and $SPI = EV/PV$; indices below 1.00 signal inefficiency against the baseline.

Track Project Deliverables and Correct Misalignments — Core Concepts II

05

A change request states reason, impact, options and recommendation; approved changes update baselines and traceability.

06

Corrective action brings performance back to plan; preventive action reduces the probability of future variance.

07

Schedule compression is applied to the current critical path and re-analysed after every change.

08

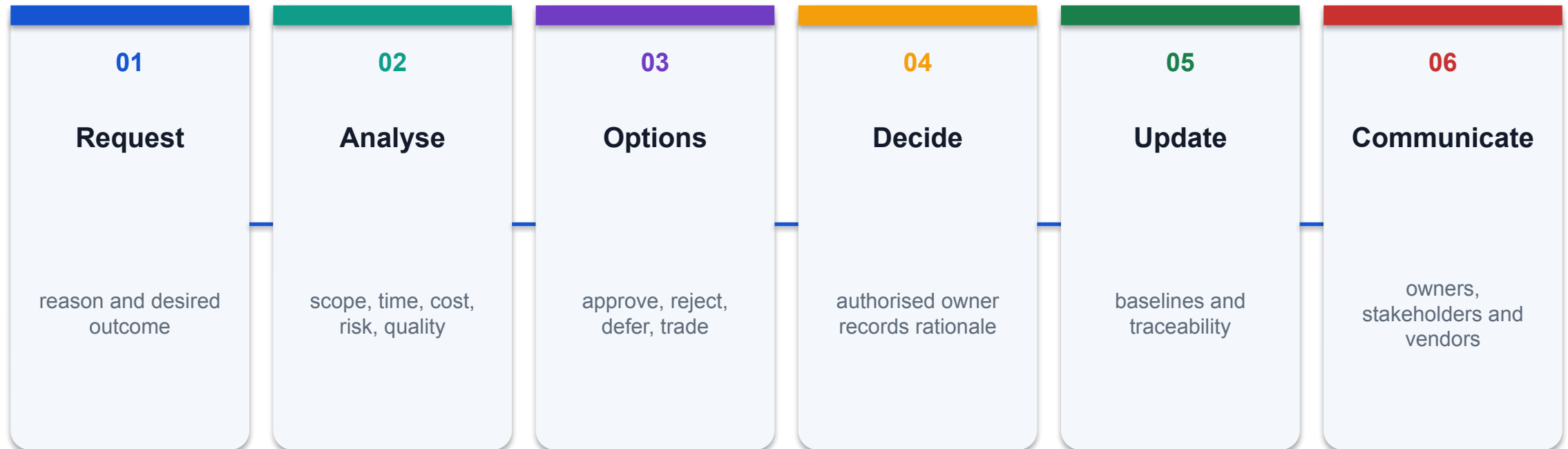
Closure confirms acceptance, transition, contract completion, records, benefits ownership and lessons learned.

Earned Value at Week 12

Measure	Formula / value	Meaning
PV	S\$108,000	Budgeted work planned
EV	S\$90,000	Budgeted value completed
AC	S\$105,000	Actual cost incurred
SPI	$EV/PV = 0.83$	Behind schedule
CPI	$EV/AC = 0.86$	Cost inefficient

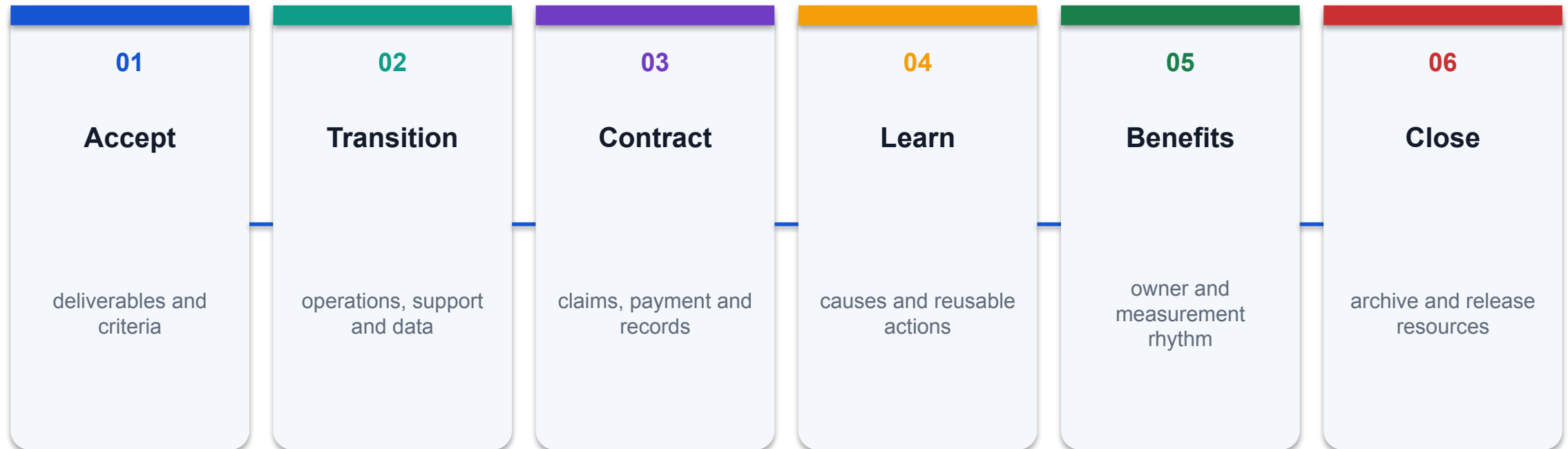
Use the indices with milestones and quality evidence—no single metric tells the whole story.

Integrated Change Control



An approved change is unfinished until affected baselines and acceptance evidence are updated.

Closeout Gates



Do not close on elapsed time; close on complete evidence and transferred accountability.

Activity 7 Tool Pack

30 Kanban Board

XLSX · editable project tool

31 Burndown Chart

XLSX · editable project tool

32 Project Budget - Planned vs Actual - Weekly and Monthly

XLSX · editable project tool

34 Control Chart

XLSX · editable project tool

44 Agile Retrospective

XLSX · editable project tool

Control the Pilot, Decide the Change and Close the Project

THE SITUATION

At the end of week 12, the baseline planned value is S\$108,000. Completed deliverables represent S\$90,000 of budgeted value and actual cost is S\$105,000. The sponsor also requests loyalty points, estimated at S\$24,000 and three weeks. Launch evidence is incomplete and the vendor wants final payment.

WHAT YOU'LL DO

Build an evidence-based status, calculate earned value, forecast outcome, analyse the change request, select corrective action, update approved baselines and complete acceptance, handover and lessons learned.

YOU'LL PRODUCE

A current Kanban and burndown, earned-value analysis with forecasts, status report, change-control decision, corrective-action log, acceptance and handover checklist, lessons learned and closure recommendation.

DONE WHEN

Earned-value calculations and forecast reconcile; the change decision states complete impacts; corrective action has an owner and due date; and closure is supported by acceptance, handover, contract and lessons evidence.

Tool: Kanban, Burndown, Budget, Control Chart and Retrospective templates

Full procedure, evidence fields and acceptance criteria: Learner Guide and Activity 7 folder.

Debrief — Activity 7: What It Proves

1

Status reporting is a decision system: variance without forecast and action is only history.

2

An approved change is not complete until every affected baseline and traceability record is updated.

3

Project closure transfers accountability for benefits and operations; it does not merely stop project work.

Topic 07 Recap

Decision

Work performance data becomes information only after comparison with the approved baseline and thresholds.

Method

$CPI = EV/AC$ and $SPI = EV/PV$; indices below 1.00 signal inefficiency against the baseline.

Evidence

A current Kanban and burndown, earned-value analysis with forecasts, status report, change-control decision, corrective-action log, acceptance and handover checklist, lessons learned and closure recommendation.

Capability

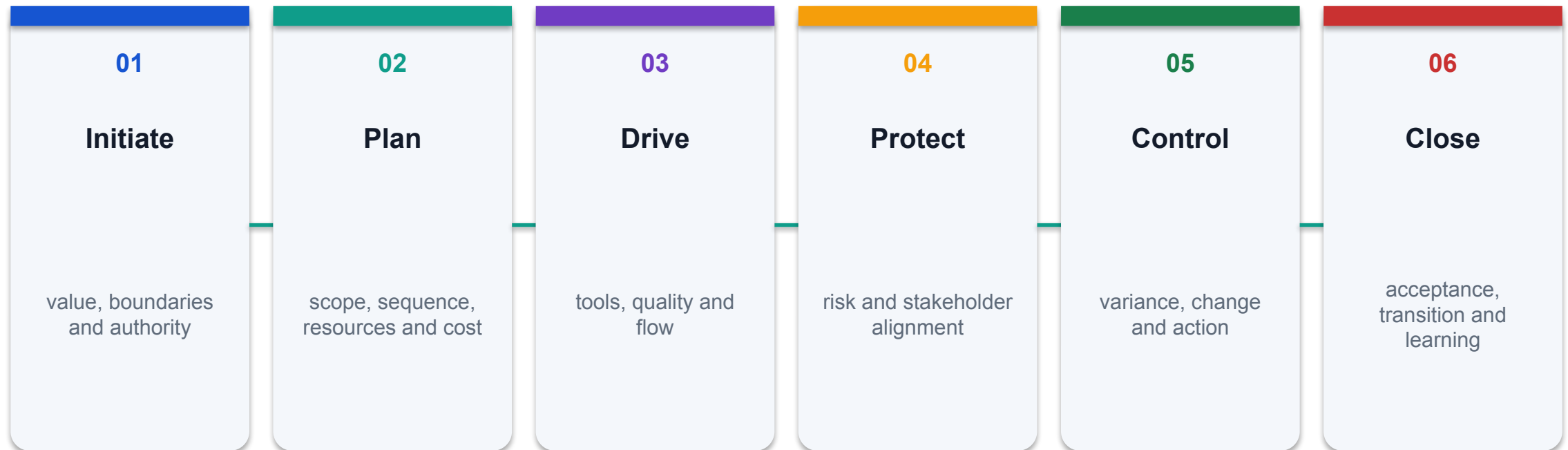
Track deliverables, monitor cost, schedule and resources, and correct misalignment (A7).

WRAP-UP

Course Wrap-Up

From authorisation to controlled handover—one connected evidence chain.

The Small-Project Delivery System



Every output becomes an input to the next decision.

Seven Takeaways

01

Start with value and measurable success, not a list of tasks.

02

Integrate scope, schedule and cost around the same work packages.

03

Choose the tool that changes the next decision and retire unused reporting.

04

Fund risk responses before triggers become issues.

05

Make accountability and stakeholder feedback visible.

06

Plan capacity at the constraint, not by nominal headcount.

07

Control through forecast and action; close through evidence and transfer.

Assessment Readiness Check

Knowledge

Can you explain the small-project elements, plan requirements, tools, risks and stakeholder identification?

Application

Can you produce and interpret the charter, baseline, quality analysis, risk register, RACI, resource plan and control evidence?

Judgement

Can you choose a method, explain the trade-off and recommend a proportionate action?

Evidence

Can you trace each recommendation to the case facts and an approved project artifact?

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Thank You!

Effective Project Management for Small Projects

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